

financial independence. Every hour spent was worth it. I feel much more safe and relaxed now. Go ahead, do it right now... Do not procrastinate; you never know what is in store tomorrow.

Be patient

A lot has already been said about the power of compound interest, but the importance of compounding can never be overstated. However, because of the way compounding works, it is very easy to lose patience. You may be saving regularly and leaving the money alone to let it grow. You feel you are doing more than your best to make sure you adhere to your plan, but the goal still seems to be far away. There will definitely be times when you may actually want to go all out and put your money in a stock in the hope that it doubles up quickly because you feel that your nest egg is not growing as fast as you would like to.

In such times, your knowledge and understanding of the way compounding works as well as your patience will pay off. If you have understood compounding, you would have understood that you earn roughly 75% of your money in the last 25% of the tenure you have planned for financial independence.

So, the magic of compounding has an inbuilt delayed gratification. Do not get impatient. Your corpus will increase exponentially after a certain stage. Give it time. I will show you some actual charts of my own financial independence journey in later sections to help you realize how this actually works in practice. This will not only help you to understand the gains that compounding brings in but also convince you to be patient and continue to be disciplined in your investments.

Remember that becoming financially independent is not like running a mere race but is more like running a marathon. You have to be patient even if you look around and see people earning more and spending more than you. You have to be rational even if you feel enough is enough and you want to quit your job now; even if you feel that you are not even reaching close to your goals. I am sure you must have watched a long distance race. I have personally been running half marathons since 2013. Do you know how